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Pinboard API Documentation (v1)

A [newer version of the Pinboard API](#) is under development. Version 1 of the API will remain available for legacy users.

The Pinboard API is a way to interact programatically with your bookmarks, notes and other Pinboard data. Wherever possible the Pinboard API uses the same syntax and method names as the Delicious V1 API.

Methods

All API methods are GET requests, even when good REST habits suggest they should use a different verb. Methods return data in XML (default) or JSON format. Click on the example link below any method to see a formatted response.

<https://api.pinboard.in/v1/posts/update>

Returns the most recent time a bookmark was added, updated or deleted. Use this before calling **posts/all** to see if the data has changed since the last fetch.

[example](#)

<https://api.pinboard.in/v1/posts/add>

Add a bookmark. Arguments with shaded background are required.

argument	type	comment
url	url	the URL of the item
description	title	Title of the item. This field is unfortunately named 'description' for backwards compatibility with the delicious API
extended	text	Description of the item. Called 'extended' for backwards compatibility with delicious API
tags	tag	List of up to 100 tags
dt	datetime	creation time for this bookmark. Defaults to current time. Datestamps more than 10 minutes ahead of server time will be reset to current server time
replace	yes/no	Replace any existing bookmark with this URL. Default is yes. If set to no, will throw an error if bookmark exists
shared	yes/no	Make bookmark public. Default is "yes" unless user has enabled the "save all bookmarks as private" user setting, in which case default is "no"
toread	yes/no	Marks the bookmark as unread. Default is "no"

[example](#)

<https://api.pinboard.in/v1/posts/delete>

Delete a bookmark. Arguments with shaded background are required.

argument	type	comment
url	url	

<https://api.pinboard.in/v1/posts/get>

Returns one or more posts on a single day matching the arguments. If no date or url is given, date of most recent bookmark will be used.

argument	type	comment
tag	tag	filter by up to three tags
dt	date	return results bookmarked on this day
url	url	return bookmark for this URL
meta	yes/no	include a change detection signature in a meta attribute

[example](#)

<https://api.pinboard.in/v1/posts/recent>

Returns a list of the user's most recent posts, filtered by tag.

argument	type	comment
tag	tag	filter by up to three tags
count	int	number of results to return. Default is 15, max is 100

example

<https://api.pinboard.in/v1/posts/dates>

Returns a list of dates with the number of posts at each date.

argument	type	comment
tag	tag	filter by up to three tags

example

<https://api.pinboard.in/v1/posts/all>

Returns all bookmarks in the user's account.

argument	type	comment
tag	tag	filter by up to three tags
start	int	offset value (default is 0)
results	int	number of results to return. Default is all
fromdt	datetime	return only bookmarks created after this time
todt	datetime	return only bookmarks created before this time
meta	int	include a change detection signature for each bookmark

example

<https://api.pinboard.in/v1/posts/suggest>

Returns a list of popular tags and recommended tags for a given URL. Popular tags are tags used site-wide for the url; recommended tags are drawn from the user's own tags.

argument	type	comment
url	url	

example

<https://api.pinboard.in/v1/tags/get>

Returns a full list of the user's tags along with the number of times they were used.

example

<https://api.pinboard.in/v1/tags/delete>

Delete an existing tag.

argument	type	comment
tag	tag	

<https://api.pinboard.in/v1/tags/rename>

Rename an tag, or fold it in to an existing tag

argument	type	comment
old	tag	note: match is not case sensitive
new	tag	if empty, nothing will happen

<https://api.pinboard.in/v1/user/secret>

Returns the user's secret RSS key (for viewing private feeds)

example

https://api.pinboard.in/v1/user/api_token/

Returns the user's API token (for making API calls without a password)

example

<https://api.pinboard.in/v1/notes/list>

Returns a list of the user's notes

example

<https://api.pinboard.in/v1/notes/ID>

Returns an individual user note. The **hash** property is a 20 character long sha1 hash of the note text.

example

Encoding

All entities are encoded as UTF-8. In the length limits below, 'characters' means logical characters rather than bytes.

All arguments should be passed URL-encoded. Where multiple arguments are allowed, they should be separated by URL-encoded whitespace (**apple+pear+orange**)

Data Types

The Pinboard API recognizes the following data types:

tag	up to 255 characters. May not contain commas or whitespace. Please be aware that tags beginning with a period are treated as private and trigger special private tag semantics .
URL	as defined by RFC 3986 . Allowed schemes are http , https , javascript , mailto , ftp and file . The Safari-specific feed scheme is allowed but will be treated as a synonym for http .
title	up to 255 characters long
text	up to 65536 characters long. Any URLs will be auto-linkified when displayed.
datetime	UTC timestamp in this format: 2010-12-11T19:48:02Z. Valid date range is Jan 1, 1 AD to January 1, 2100 (but see note below about future timestamps).
date	UTC date in this format: 2010-12-11. Same range as datetime above
yes/no	the literal string 'yes' or 'no'
md5	32 character hexadecimal MD5 hash
integer	integer in the range 0..2 ³²
format	the literal string 'json' or 'xml'

Authentication

The Pinboard v1 API requires you to use HTTPS. There are two ways to authenticate:

1. Regular HTTP Auth:
https://user:password@api.pinboard.in/v1/method
2. API authentication tokens:
https://api.pinboard.in/v1/method?auth_token=user:NNNNNN

An authentication token is a short opaque identifier in the form "username:TOKEN".

Users can find their API token on their **settings page**. They can request a new token at any time; this will invalidate their previous API token.

Any third-party sites making API requests on behalf of Pinboard users from an outside server **MUST** use this authentication method instead of storing the user's password. Violators will be blocked from using the API.

Rate Limits

API requests are limited to one call per user every three seconds, except for the following:

- posts/all** - once every five minutes
- posts/recent** - once every minute

If you need to make unusually heavy use of the API, please consider **discussing it with me** first, to avoid unhappiness.

Make sure your API clients check for **429 Too Many Requests** server errors and back off appropriately. If possible, keep doubling the interval between requests until you stop receiving errors.

Error Handling

The Pinboard API does its best to mimic the behavior Delicious API. If something goes wrong, you'll get the mysterious:

```
<result code="something went wrong" />
```

If an action succeeds, you'll get:

```
<result code="done" />
```

Or their JSON equivalents.

Differences From Delicious API

- 1. Pinboard is way more awesome.
- 2. No support for tag bundles.
- 3. `posts/update` does not return an `inboxnew` attribute.
- 4. `posts/delete` returns

```
<result code="item not found" />
```

if the user does not have that URL in their bookmarks. Delicious does not return an error in this context.
- 5. `posts/get` - Pinboard response does not include a "tag" attribute.
- 6. `posts/get` - the `hashes` argument is not supported.
- 7. `posts/all?hashes` is not implemented
- 8. `posts/suggest` - the top level element is called 'suggested' rather than 'suggest'

Support

To report bugs in the API or this documentation, please contact support@pinboard.in. If you have an API feature idea, please post it to the Google group ([pinboard-dev](#)) for discussion.

You can find me on Twitter as [@pinboard](#) and on IRC as #pinboard on freenode.

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